

To trying new things

U s gamers are a fickle bunch. We may complain a lot about some things, but still continue to keep doing said things *cough*pre-ordering*cough* over and over again. That being said, we're usually a hard lot to please. We hype easily, and are just as easily disappointed. This puts game developers and publishers in a rather difficult position. Yes, I know, *whaaat? Is this guy really taking their side?* But hear me out.

Everything publishers and developers do, is done with the end goal of making as much profit as possible. Understandable, at the end of the day, it's business. However, companies know that the best course of action for them to reap the maximum profits is to not disappoint us. This, in turn, means that they will take as little risk as possible. That's the key word here, risk. With gaming being the billion dollar industry it is, everybody wants to play it safe, nobody wants to gamble on something new. This means we're always going to keep getting iterations of the same franchises; think EA's sports games, all of the Call of Dutys and Battlefields, the Far Cry's and Assassin's Creeds, games we've just come to expect every year. And every year, without fail, gamers will buy these games. They'll have a lot of the same complaints, there might be one-offs in between that are really good, but companies know they can rely on these franchises for steady income.

Because of this, few AAA companies ever want to launch new IPs, outside of Indie studios who don't own any major IP to begin with. The game that got me thinking about this was Bethesda's upcoming title, Starfield, which also happens to be a new IP. I honestly couldn't care less about it at first. I'd rather they worked on a new Fallout, or The Elder Scrolls VI, both of which are franchises that I'm familiar with and have enjoyed in the past. However, at some point in time, both of these were new IPs too. You never know, Starfield might just be the next huge RPG franchise for



Bethesda. Dragon Age: Origins, a game I'm very fond of, was a huge gamble for BioWare at the time, they were still riding high on the success of another new IP they had just released 2 years prior – Mass Effect, and both of them have gone on to spawn very successful franchises of their own. I still pretend Andromeda never happened. Every successful franchise today was a fresh new IP, only times were different, and I guess gamers were more eager to try out new stuff? Or maybe that hasn't changed, and it's just me.

I know that this year, I'm going to be more open minded about trying new IPs, and maybe even dip into genres I haven't explored before. And also, Happy New Year everyone! *

–Manish “Trigger-Happy” Rajesh

SKOAR! Overlord | feedback@skoar.in